



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Assumption Catholic School

School Website: <https://assumptioncatholicschools.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**Classicality Audit: Augustine School (Jackson, TN)**

Website audited: <https://www.augustineschool.com>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Why: Augustine School's public materials strongly affirm classical aims in their religious and metaphysical foundations and in their stated purpose (formation toward truth, goodness, beauty; virtue and wisdom). They clearly identify as "Biblically-Based," "Gospel-Centered," and "Classically-Informed," and emphasize partnering with families. However, the crawl data contains limited explicit evidence for the classical curriculum specifics (Trivium/Quadrivium, Latin, Great Books) and explicit pedagogical markers (Socratic seminar, chanting/memory work, scholé) required to award a fully CLASSICAL rating using the Six Elements keyword framework. With modest additions to public-facing pages (see "What would move the needle"), Augustine could readily exhibit a CLASSICAL profile. Key site signals include "form students who love goodness, truth, and beauty," "forming wise and virtuous young men and women," "Biblically-Based," "Gospel-Centered," and "partner with families". Community-facing posts such as an ACCS accreditation announcement and a "Season of Prayer Guide" further reinforce mission alignment and communal devotion.

Scoring below follows the required Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators from "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School" and the lexicon groupings (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations; Purpose & Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; Parents & Community).

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

- What we found on the school site (keywords/phrases):
- "love goodness, truth, and beauty"; "wise and virtuous"; "Biblically-Based"; "Gospel-Centered"; "Students grow in their understanding and love of God's Word...relate all things...to Jesus Christ"; "submit all knowledge...to the Lordship of Christ".
- Community devotion: "Season of Prayer Guide" (communal prayer).
- Comparison to Six Elements Positive/Negative indicators:
- Positive matches: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; wisdom; Christian worldview/theology; faith and reason; liturgical/communal prayer signals (season of prayer).
- No negative indicators detected (e.g., value-neutrality, relativism).
- Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: +10 (e.g., truth/goodness/beauty [3], virtue/wisdom [2], Biblically-Based [1], Gospel-Centered [1], God's Word/Christ-centered [2], communal prayer [1]); Negative hits: -0.
- Percent positive: 100%; Coverage of sub-criteria (moral realism, theology, liturgy/communal practices): 3/3 = 100%.
- Rating: CLASSICAL
- Rationale: Strong, explicit theological grounding and transcendental moral realism; clear communal worship/prayer signals align with the Six Elements' positive list.

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

- What we found:
- “form students who love goodness, truth, and beauty”; “forming wise and virtuous young men and women”; “inspire a lifelong love of learning”.
- Comparison to Six Elements:
- Positive matches: cultivation of wisdom and virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; emphasis on formation over mere information.
- No negative markers like “college and career ready”/“21st-century skills” emphasis present in mission framing.
- Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: +7 (virtue, wisdom, truth/goodness/beauty, love of learning/formation language); Negative hits: -0.
- Percent positive: 100%; Coverage of sub-criteria (virtue/wisdom, formation, T-G-B realism): 3/3 = 100%.
- Rating: CLASSICAL
- Rationale: Mission statements directly echo the classical telos and formation aims as defined in the framework.

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

- What we found:
- “Classically-Informed...classical model of education”; emphasis on “excellent literature” and “finest art”.
- General academics language: “exceptional curriculum...distinctively Christian and classically informed” and “Discover the Good, the True, and the Beautiful with Classical Christian Education”.
- No explicit public mention in the crawl of Trivium/Quadrivium, Latin/Greek, Great Books, or “history” (vs. “social studies”).
- Comparison to Six Elements:
- Partial positive signals (classical model; literature/the arts align with Great Books/fine arts ideals).
- Missing explicit markers: Trivium/Quadrivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric, arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy), Latin/Greek, Great Books/primary texts, and explicit “history” framing.
- Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: +3 (classical model, literature, arts); Negative hits: -0.
- Percent positive: 100% of detected hits; Coverage of sub-criteria (Liberal Arts, Great Books/Great Conversation, integrated/history, wonder): approx. 2/4 = 50%.
- Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Rationale: Clear classical intent but insufficient explicit curricular detail in the crawl to confirm full classical content (e.g., Trivium/Quadrivium, Latin, Great Books) per the keyword framework.

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

- What we found:
- No explicit references in the crawl to “Socratic,” “dialectic,” “seminar,” “chanting,” “recitation,” “memory work,” “scholé,” or student rhetoric theses/opportunities.
- Comparison to Six Elements:
- Lacking explicit positive pedagogical markers (Socratic seminar, restful learning/scholé, chanting/recitation, imitation/progymnasmata).
- No contrary negative markers detected (e.g., heavy project-based/constructivist emphasis).
- Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: +0; Negative hits: -0.
- Percent positive: 0%; Coverage of sub-criteria (Socratic, scholé, chanting/memory, imitation, rhetoric opportunities): 0/5 = 0%.
- Rating: NOT CLASSICAL (on publicly available pedagogy signals)

- Rationale: Absence of explicit pedagogical evidence in the crawl data. Note: If the school ends at grade 8, missing Socratic/seminar would be less decisive; Augustine serves PK–12 per site stats, so explicit pedagogy markers matter more.

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

- What we found:
- “engaging faculty,” “wonderful teachers and administration,” and language about “shaping young minds and hearts” suggest formation-minded teachers, but no public “portrait of a teacher,” faculty-as-living-curriculum, or formal mentor language found in crawl.
- Comparison to Six Elements:
- Partial alignment with teachers as mentors/models of virtue; lacking explicit faculty formation/collegiality/portrait statements in public text.
- Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: +3 (engaging faculty; teachers shaping hearts; excellence emphasis); Negative hits: -0.
- Percent positive: 100% of detected; Coverage of sub-criteria (model teachers, living curriculum/collegiality, explicit portraits): $\sim 1/4 = 25\%$.
- Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Rationale: Good signals of mentor-formation posture; missing explicit teacher profile and formation language.

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

- What we found:
- “partner with families to develop a student’s intellect, character, and faith”.
- “February Mommy + Me” community event inviting families to experience the school and “learn more about the classical Christian education Augustine School provides” (parent-formation/engagement).
- Community devotional resource (“Season of Prayer Guide”) indicating shared communal practices.
- Comparison to Six Elements:
- Positive matches: partnership with families; parent formation/education events; intentional community rhythms.
- Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: +3; Negative hits: -0.
- Percent positive: 100%; Coverage of sub-criteria (partnership, parent formation, open/welcome culture): $\sim 2/3 - 3/3$; conservative coverage 67%.
- Rating: CLASSICAL
- Rationale: Clear, explicit partnership language and recurring parent/community engagement.

Aggregate Classification

- Category ratings: C1 CLASSICAL; C2 CLASSICAL; C3 SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL; C4 NOT CLASSICAL; C5 SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL; C6 CLASSICAL.
 - Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Basis: Strong metaphysical/theological and mission aims; positive parent/community posture; incomplete public specificity on curriculum and pedagogy per the Six Elements keyword framework.
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What would move the needle

To present a fully CLASSICAL profile via public materials, Augustine School should: - Curriculum page updates - Name the Trivium and Quadrivium explicitly; list grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry,

music, astronomy; show sample reading lists and “Great Books/primary sources” for upper grades; highlight Latin/Greek study and “history” (use “history,” not only “social studies”). - Pedagogy page - Describe K–6 memory work, chanting, singing, recitation; note upper school Socratic seminars/debates; mention rhetoric orations/thesis capstones; consider adopting/mentioning scholé/restful learning language as appropriate. - Faculty formation - Publish a “Portrait of a Teacher/Graduate,” emphasizing teachers as mentors and the “living curriculum,” plus any classical pedagogy training the faculty receives. - Parent formation - Centralize ongoing parent education (book clubs, talks, classical education explainers) and highlight these on the website (you already run family-facing events like “Mommy + Me”).

Evidence highlights (from the crawl)

- Mission and three pillars: “Biblically-Based...Gospel-Centered...Classically-Informed,” pursuit of “goodness, truth, and beauty,” “wise and virtuous” formation.
 - Community life: ACCS accreditation news; “Season of Prayer Guide”.
 - Parent/community invitation: “February Mommy + Me” (learn more about classical education at Augustine School).
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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